

Company Laptop Setup and Access Guide

New-device preparation, secure configuration, application access, and handover

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Important: Northstar Digital Services is a fictional company created solely for RAG, document retrieval, citation, and corporate AI training exercises. These procedures are illustrative and are not instructions for any real organization.

1. Purpose

This procedure describes the fictional NDS workflow for preparing a newly issued laptop. It is designed for employees, hiring managers, and first-line IT support. Only approved company tools, applications, and enrollment workflows should be used. Actual steps may differ by operating system and device-management platform.

2. Roles and responsibilities

- **Employee:** verify the asset tag, complete identity verification, enroll the device using approved instructions, and report setup failures.
- **Manager:** confirm the employee's role, required applications, access groups, and any approved exception.
- **IT provisioning:** record the asset, apply the standard device profile, verify encryption and endpoint protection, and release the laptop.
- **Application owner:** approve access based on job responsibilities and least privilege.

3. Before first sign-in

- Check the laptop packaging and device for visible damage. Report missing accessories or damage before use.
- Confirm the asset tag matches the assignment record. Do not exchange devices informally.
- Use a trusted network to complete initial setup. Follow the IT team's instructions if a secure enrollment network is required.
- Have the employee's approved corporate identity and MFA method ready. Never share passwords or one-time codes with another person.
- Ensure the laptop is connected to power during enrollment, updates, and encryption setup.

4. Standard setup workflow

Step 1 — Confirm device assignment

Compare the asset tag and serial number with the service request. If the device belongs to another employee or the record does not match, stop and contact IT asset management.

Step 2 — Connect to a trusted network

Connect to the approved office network or another network allowed by policy. Avoid unknown networks during initial setup.

Step 3 — Enroll the device

Use the company-provided enrollment portal or managed setup flow. Confirm that the device appears in the approved device-management console. Do not install unofficial management profiles.

Step 4 — Sign in and verify identity

Use the employee's corporate account and approved MFA process. If sign-in fails, use the identity recovery process rather than repeatedly guessing passwords.

Step 5 — Apply updates

Allow the managed operating-system, browser, and security updates to complete. Restart when prompted. Do not postpone critical security updates without an approved exception.

Step 6 — Verify security controls

Confirm that disk encryption, endpoint protection, screen lock, firewall and device compliance are enabled according to the standard device profile. Escalate failed compliance checks.

Step 7 — Install approved applications

Use the managed company software catalog. Install only applications authorized for the role. For missing software, request it through the service portal.

Step 8 — Configure collaboration tools

Sign in to approved email, calendar, chat, meeting, and document applications. Verify access without copying company data into personal accounts.

Step 9 — Test remote access

If the role requires remote access, follow the VPN guide and confirm that required internal resources are available.

Step 10 — Complete handover

Confirm that the employee can sign in, access required applications, lock the screen, and find the IT support channel. Update the asset record and close the request only after checks pass.

5. Application and data access

- Access should be tied to a business role and approved by the relevant manager or application owner.
- Request only the permissions needed for the assigned duties. Avoid broad administrator rights unless formally approved.
- Use separate approved workflows for privileged access, production systems, customer data, and financial applications.
- If an application is missing after setup, record the application name, business purpose, manager approval and any error message in the service request.
- Do not work around an access denial by using another employee's account.

6. Troubleshooting table

Issue	Checks	Next action
Cannot sign in	Username, keyboard layout, network, identity service status	Use approved account recovery; contact service desk if locked
Device not compliant	Enrollment status, updates, encryption, endpoint protection	Sync through managed tool; send compliance details to IT
Application absent	Role profile, software catalog, approved request	Request installation and manager/application-owner approval
Email not syncing	Network, account status, service status, storage quota if shown	Capture error and create ticket; do not export mailbox data to personal storage
VPN unavailable	Internet, client version, VPN service status	Follow NDS-IT-KB-014 VPN Troubleshooting Guide
Lost or damaged device	Location/time and potential exposure of data	Report immediately through asset and security incident channels

7. Security and privacy rules

- Keep the device physically secure and lock the screen when unattended.
- Store work files only in approved company locations. Do not forward sensitive material to personal email or consumer cloud storage.
- Do not share devices or sessions with family members or unauthorized colleagues.
- Report suspected phishing, unexpected MFA prompts, lost devices, or exposure of company data immediately.
- Do not install unapproved remote-access tools, browser extensions, or software packages.

8. Completion checklist

- ■ Asset tag verified and assigned
- ■ Device enrolled in management
- ■ Corporate identity and MFA tested
- ■ Required updates completed
- ■ Encryption and endpoint protection confirmed
- ■ Role-based applications available
- ■ Remote access tested if required
- ■ Employee shown how to contact support
- ■ Asset and service records updated

9. Frequently asked questions

Can I install any software I need?

No. Use the approved software catalog or submit a request explaining the business need.

Can IT ask me for my password to finish setup?

No. IT should use approved delegated or remote-support workflows; do not disclose your password or MFA code.

What if my manager approved an app but I cannot access it?

Confirm the request includes the correct application and role, then ask the application owner or service desk to check provisioning.

Can I use a personal USB drive to transfer work files?

Only if the device and transfer method are explicitly approved by policy. Otherwise use approved company storage and transfer tools.